Q+A

ROLES THAT MATTER

***RAJIT KAPUR** is playing a Bengali detective in Kaisi Ye Paheli, which will have its world premiere at the New York Indian Film Festival on June 21*



Q. You play a Bengali detective in the murder mystery *Kaisi Ye Paheli*. How does it compare to your role of the iconic Byomkesh Bakshi over three decades ago?
This was a fresh approach. This detective is different from Byomkesh, who was a common man. Here, he is more of a bureaucratic detective who's part of the government circle. That's why I agreed—to break the earlier detective mould.

Q. Last year, you made a comeback on television with *Sardar: The Game Changer*. What made you return to TV?
It was the opportunity and the challenge to play Sardar Patel. I have played Gandhi, Nehru and Modi and people kept asking when I was going to play Sardar Patel. So, when that chance came, I told myself that I need to do this as it will allow me to understand this man as well.

Q. Are you looking to direct something now?
I would like to, maybe for the stage or for an OTT platform, but I'm looking for something that will give me sleepless nights. It has to shake me up to want to do it. Ten years ago, it would have been much easier but, today, I am less patient. Whatever will be, will be.

Q. You have been acting for almost four decades. What does a script need to offer someone who has explored various mediums and roles?
It has to push or excite me. That excitement or push could be from the people I am working with or it could be something extraordinary in the role that I have to attempt. If there is a part that I have never done earlier or something that would stretch me as an actor—that gets me excited.

—with Deepali Dhingra